Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association
Lakewood Village, Sunnyvale, California
March, 2002
Volume 45, Number 3
Circulation 1,700

To subscribe to the Lakewood Village mailing list, send a blank email to: lakewoodvillage-subscribe@topica.com

Next LVNA Meeting:

Wednesday, March 13th, 7:00 pm, Fairwood School

Magkakaroon po nang pagpupulong ang LVNA
sa Marso 13, 2002, 7:00 p.m. sa Fairwood School.

Proxima junta de LVNA sera efectuada
el Marzo 13, 2002 a las 7:00 p.m en la escuela Fairwood.

Traffic is on the Agenda for the March LVNA Meeting

Don't miss this meeting, it will impact you!!
- Craig Crawford

Jack Witthaus from the City of Sunnyvale will be giving a report on the results of a traffic study that has been done in Lakewood. The study was conducted to address traffic that has been caused by the Mercado theaters on the neighborhood. If you have noticed an increase in neighborhood traffic then you don't want to miss this speaker. We will be looking for results and ideas to minimize traffic impact on the neighborhood.

Councilman Tim Risch of the City of Sunnyvale was invited to talk about the proposed expansion of the carrying capacity for Lawrence Expressway by the County of Santa Clara. Tim is the City representative for this project on the County committee.

If you haven't heard, the County wants traffic to flow better on the County expressways. There is a possibility that the intersection of Sandia / Lakehaven with Lawrence Expressway will be closed down, and that would mean that the Fairwood side would have to go to Tasman and make a U-turn to get to the other side of Lakewood, and the Lakewood side would have to go to Duane or Arques and make a U-turn to get to the Fairwood side. If this happens, it effectively splits the neighborhood in half ► and makes access to Lakewood shopping center very inconvenient. Other possibilities are on the table but we need to make our opinions count so be at this meeting to hear the possibilities and to learn of the Lawrence Expressway traffic project. ■

Elections are coming

- Craig Crawford

Elections are coming in April, and we need to have a slate of volunteers to fill the board positions. I will be running for President. At the March monthly meeting, we will be taking nominations for the offices of president, 1st vice president, 2nd vice president, treasurer, and secretary. If you need a job description, come to the March membership meeting to look it over. It is the volunteers who make this organization truly great, and it only takes a few hours per month for any of the positions. You will be rewarded with excellent fellowship, a new understanding of your neighborhood, and a chance to make Lakewood a better place to live and to raise families. Step up and take the challenge. You won't be sorry! ■

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President's Column

- Craig Crawford

We have had an overwhelming amount of acclaim for the new format of the newsletter. Our new Editor, Brian Smithson, has become an enthusiastic member of the LVNA family and has wonderful ideas on how to make the newsletter even better. If you have ideas and articles be sure to get them to Brian [see "From the Editor's Desk" for details].

I drove around the neighborhood with Rich Gutierrez last Thursday just to understand how Neighborhood Preservation works and what he is looking for when he is doing his job as Neighborhood Preservation Specialist for the City of Sunnyvale. I was dismayed by how many garbage containers that have been left out in view of the street several days past garbage pickup day. I was embarrassed for the neighborhood. We drove down 5 streets and took the address of 40 houses that had their garbage containers out, violating Sunnyvale code. These houses will get letters explaining the city policy on garbage containers and explaining the fines for violating the code.

How can our neighborhood be taken seriously if we can't even get our garbage cans off the street? I don't have an answer, but it shames the whole neighborhood.

We also saw garage conversions that have been turned into rentals. It was rather obvious when you see a garage with a mailbox by the entry to it and another mailbox by the front door of the main house.

Rich also explained the violation for having a paved over front yard for parking. He showed me an example of a house that he cited for have too much front yard paving and how the resident have now complied: Before, the front yard was covered by different colored paving stones, not looking to bad but not to city code; however, what the resident did to comply was to throw the paving stones into a scattered heap, which really made it look bad. While they are complying to the code, they made the situation worse. This is a situation that went from bad to worse and the neighborhood pays for it.

We also looked at junk cars and overgrown landscapes. ▶ Rich has a job that is tough and thankless but he is good at it and we are lucky to have a motivated person assigned to Lakewood. ■

From the Editor's Desk

- Editor

Newsletter Photo Image Quality

Last month, I included a few thumbnail-sized photos in the newsletter. They looked fine in the original, but the printed copies looked terrible. Because this is a volunteer effort with limited staffing, we don't have a publication process that includes a review of a "proof" copy. I'll be working with the printers to see how I can better prepare photographs in subsequent editions.

To contact the Editor of the LVNA Villager…

Send your articles, comments, and corrections by email to lvna_editor@yahoo.com, by FAX to (408)738-2821, or by postal mail to LVNA Villager, c/o Brian Smithson, 1104 Burntwood Court, Sunnyvale CA 94089. ■



Newsletter Walkers Needed

- Elena Anderson

Your LVNA is in need of a few good folks to help get the message out. It takes only a few minutes a month, gets you out of the house into the fresh air, and gives you an opportunity to meet some of your neighbors. If you can devote some time as a Newsletter Walker, please call Elena at 745-6028. It's a great way to make a contribution to the Neighborhood! ■

Support our Advertisers!

- Editor

Along with the efforts of our volunteers, the advertisers make it possible for us to distribute this newsletter to you every month, for free! ■



How Far We Have Come

- Brian Smithson

I've been reading some historical Villager newsletters and neighborhood association meeting minutes (see "Lakewood Village History Project" in last month's issue), and I happened upon an unusually passionate letter from a Lakewood Village resident urging the neighborhood association to *not* bring up a particular issue at an upcoming meeting. The year was 1964, and the issue was Proposition 14. Since I was only nine years old at that time, and was living in Washington State, I was unfamiliar with this proposition, but this letter captured my interest and so I looked into it further. Some of you may already know about it, but for the rest of us, let me fill you in on some California history:

I used to think that neighborhood segregation was something that happened in the South, but *de facto* segregation was quite common in California and throughout the country. For example, it was not unusual to find restrictive covenants on residential property deeds that prohibited the owner from selling their property to people of particular racial, ethnic, or religious backgrounds. Many of these covenants are still on the books, but they are not legally enforceable. In 1959, the California State Legislature enacted the Unruh Civil Rights Act that made this kind of discrimination illegal for public housing. In 1963, the Rumford Act extended equal housing opportunity beyond the realm of public housing.

However, a backlash occurred in 1964, and a proposition to repeal the Rumford act was put on the California ballot. This is ironic when you consider that 1964 was the year that the Federal government put into law a sweeping Civil Rights act. Nonetheless, Proposition 14 passed by a margin of over 65% statewide, ► and it wasn't only the traditionally conservative areas of the state that voted in favor of Proposition 14 – even San Francisco County voters passed the measure. It was a divisive and highly charged issue at the time, and few years later, the California Supreme Court overturned Proposition 14 as unconstitutional. Today, we have fair housing and fair lending laws in place.

After reading about this, I wondered what could have possessed so many Californians to vote in favor of Proposition 14? As far as I can determine, it was primarily the result of fear and ignorance. Neighborhoods were far more segregated then than they are now, and some people feared that when "minorities" moved into a predominantly white neighborhood, their property values would decline. Unfortunately, it became self-fulfilling if those fears caused the white people to move out: as people and businesses moved away, the local tax base was reduced, causing a reduction in local services, which in turn caused a lasting decline in the neighborhood's intrinsic value.

So what does this have to do with Lakewood Village today? Our neighborhood enjoys amazing diversity, and that diversity is one of the things that I love about Lakewood Village. I don't have current statistics for Lakewood Village, but the 2000 Census for Sunnyvale says that the city is 32% Asian, 15% Hispanic, and 11% other non-Caucasians. I suspect that Lakewood Village is even more diverse than that. Compare that to a 1960 Urban Renewal survey which says that Lakewood Village was 98% white!

Did our property values decline with the growth of such diversity? *No, a home worth $15,000 in 1957 is likely worth $400,000 today. That's a 7.6% compounded annual rate of return, easily outperforming the Dow Jones Industrial and S&P 500 stock indexes over the same period.*

Did our diversity cause any new problems, like the ones you read about from time to time in this newsletter: junker cars, shopping carts, weeds, crime, trash cans left out, vandalism and graffiti, peeling paint, kids hanging out around commercial establishments, etc.? *No, you may be surprised to know that nearly all of those problems have been widely reported in the Villager newsletter as early as 1959!*

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As far as I can tell, the only things that have truly changed in Lakewood Village are that we have many more cars per person, there are more residents per household (a matter of economics more than ethnicity), we use a lot more electricity, and instead of the mosquitoes and crickets that used to plague this area, now we have those annoying little ants.

My point is this: when we look at how to solve neighborhood problems, let's look at the issues head-on and not try to assign blame to one group of people or another. Most of our neighborhood issues have been around for longer than most of us have lived here, and they have not resulted from any particular group of people joining the neighborhood. When we solve these problems, we'll do so by addressing them as generic "people problems" and not as specific "problem people".

With that in mind, I'll be out clearing up some of the weeds and litter in my front yard this month. Maybe I'll see you out there! ■



43 Years Ago in Lakewood Village

- Editor

Lakewood School was completed in March of 1959. (Fairwood School, our first neighborhood school, opened in 1956)

Also in March of 1959, the Lakewood Shell gas station opened for business. ■

Neighborhood Preservation:

A Tour of Lakewood Village

- Richard Gutierrez

Over the past month, the Neighborhood Preservation Division has been circulating the Lakewood Village area. During these visits through your neighborhood, many violations were noted. Sixty courtesy notices were mailed to residents informing them that their trash and recycling containers were in violation and were not being stored properly.

The City of Sunnyvale requires residents to store trash and recycling containers out of view from the street. Containers may be placed at the curb the day before collection pick-up and must be returned to a storage area out of the public view by the end of the collection day.

Please be aware that if you are found in violation of the SMC 19.38.030, you may be issued a citation of $25.00 for each day the violation exists.

This ordinance was enacted to enhance the visual image of the community.

In addition to storing trash containers properly, you can improve the appearance and safety of your home and neighborhood by placing your trash and recyclables in the appropriate containers and keeping the container lids closed. This reduces the amount of litter and debris that is blown about the community and helps control insects and rodents by eliminating the food source.

For more information, contact:

Richard Gutierrez
City of Sunnyvale
Neighborhood Preservation Specialist
(408) 730-7447 ■



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From the Police Blotter: Lakewood Village and nearby areas

- Courtesy of the Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety



Editor's note: this month's report is much more serious than last month. If you see suspicious activity or are aware of any crime, no matter how minor it may seem, please report it to Sunnyvale's Department of Public Safety. Emergencies should be called into 911, and non-emergencies should be called into 730-7100.

Wildwood 2/23/02 Consent search resulting in discovery of a small amount of Marijuana.

Blazingwood 2/23/02 Auto burglary (car stereo and CD's stolen)

Lakeside 2/24/02 Bicycle theft.

Meadowlake 2/24/02 Sexual offenses

Lakebird 2/25/02 Domestic violence, violation of restraining order, resisting arrest and prowling.

Lakebird 2/25/02 False crime report regarding spousal battery.

Columbia Middle School 2/25/02 Graffiti. The spray paint tags were of the Sureno gang.

Palomos 2/25/02 Terror threats, assault and battery, and corporal injury on child with traumatic condition.

Lakeside 2/26/02 Domestic violence, criminal threats, and false imprisonment. ■

The Parrots are Back!

- Brian Smithson

On a recent Sunday morning, I was delighted to see a flock of about a dozen wild parrots in Lakewood Village. These parrots are mostly Mitred Conures (shown in the photograph, below) and they have lived at St. Martin's on Central Avenue in Sunnyvale for at least ten years. There is a flock of approximately 60 parrots in San Francisco and there is also a flock in Palo Alto.



Photo courtesy of Mark Bittner
Visit www.pelicanmedia.com

Nobody knows precisely how the parrots came to live in the Bay Area, but it was probably not through migration. Conures are native to Mexico and Central and South America, and it is more likely they were lost or escaped pets that became successful living and breeding in the wild with our mild Bay Area climate.

I don't know much about wild birds or their feeding habits, but these parrots seem to like to crunch on the buds of trees around here, and I usually see and hear them at least once each year in the springtime.

If you hear a lot of squawking or a strange crunching sound, look up in the trees and you might be delighted to see them too! ■

Ask the Officer

- Crime Prevention Unit
Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety

Q: I'm confused about the new child car seat law. Is it 6 years old and 60 pounds? What if I have an 8 year old who only weighs 55 pounds?

A: The new law says children must be secured in an appropriate child passenger restraint (safety seat or booster seat) until they are at least 6 years old or weigh 60 lbs.

Q: Is skateboarding illegal?

A: 10.12.035 of the Sunnyvale Municipal Code states that it is unlawful for any person to ride or operate any skateboard or similar device on the roadway portion of any street, nor shall any person in any retail commercial district, ride on or operate any skateboard or similar device on any sidewalk or public or privately owned parking lot. In short, it is illegal under certain circumstances. ■

Crime Prevention Tips

- Crime Prevention Unit
Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety

Child Safety on the Internet

- Place the computer in a centrally located area in your home-not in a child's bedroom. This prevents "secret" communications or access.
- Talk with your children about the Internet. Explain that it is an excellent source of information, but some sites are inappropriate and they are expected to stay away from these sites.
- Establish time frames for Internet access.
- Keep an open line of communication with your children. Discuss their Internet experiences and guide them to sites that are age-appropriate.
- Consider installing software that can block or filter Internet sites or certain words that may indicate inappropriate sites.

If you allow your child to go into chat rooms…

- Teach him/her never to give out any personal information including: name, address, city, state, school attended, phone number, family names or other family information.
- Select age-appropriate chat rooms. The larger Internet Service Providers (ISP) have moderated chat rooms with appropriate themes.
- Never respond to someone who wants to meet in person or send photographs. Instruct your children to exit the chat room and notify you immediately if this happens.

Remember, ***Ask the Officer*** relies on questions from the community. If you have a Public Safety question please write to the Crime Prevention Unit, Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety, 700 All America Way, Sunnyvale, CA 94086, or call (408)730-7140, or you can email your question to lvna_editor@yahoo.com and it will be forwarded to the City. ■





Family Daycare, Part 2

- James and Gerlinde Daugherty

Last time I wrote about family daycare I gave a very basic facts-only look at family daycare business. With the limited space I have, there is much to say, and so will try to give a more personal view of family daycare using our daycare experiences as material.

Budgeting

My wife and I use an Excel spreadsheet on a home computer to keep track of our income, expenses, and do our budgeting. This spread sheet has a column for each of our expense categories plus a reserve column so we can track a specific cost. These costs are averaged for the year on an ongoing basis and are posted next to a column with the same category item from last year. This allows us to see how our expenses compare to last year. We know on a weekly basis if we are going to have to cut expenses or raise rates.

Our reserve column that we use for tracking a specific cost is to see if the cost of this item is excessive or can be eliminated some how. One item we tracked was the cost of diapers for one year. We discovered that we were spending $700 per year on diapers.

Instead of raising rates we asked our parents to begin bringing their own. Everyone benefited. Only the parents with diapered children picked up the extra cost, thus it was unnecessary to raise everyone's rate. The amount saved allowed us to pass the savings on to other categories that were getting out of budget and needed an expense increase.

To benefit our long term parents, when we see that we are getting close to needing a rate increase we attempt to raise incoming parents first, then our regular parents if necessary. Also rate increases are scheduled for the beginning of the year whenever possible.

To supplement cost controls we are also on the State food program and apply for grants whenever they become available.

Family Daycare means Family

Our parents, or clients, are very much treated like an extended family to us. Even though it is in our contract to charge for overtime we seldom if ever do. With the economy and Silicon Valley traffic the way it is, we don't want any of our parents risking their lives trying to save on overtime.

One of our parents a few years back had an older child in a preschool and had to make two stops for her children. The preschool charged her a dollar a minute in overtime after 6 p.m. She lived in Gilroy and worked in Santa Clara. She's retired now, in her early forties, and last we heard, is living on her husband's income.

We make arts and Crafts projects with our children as part of our educational program. Some of our older children that have left us for preschool miss having something to show mom and dad like their younger brothers or sisters do, so occasionally we'll put together a kit for an older sibling so the parents can work together on it with them when they get home.

At least once a year we will put on a party, rent an astrojump, and have a buffet type lunch for our kids, and their parents. Also invited to these parties are children and their parents who have left us, sometime years ago. We occasionally do childcare for our parents that want an evening out without the kids. Sometimes over night and sometimes on a weekend night. We work extra time for parents who get stuck in meetings or rush hour traffic. This is part of the business. Ten-hour days are just about a norm for us.

War Stories from the Front

While working in this business you get to meet and talk to many people, parents, social workers, and other providers. You hear a lot of stories and share happenings with each other. Here are some of those stories.

When my wife first started her daycare one of our clients was a single working mom who obviously was quite worn down from her routine. One morning she showed up at our daycare as usual, but with out her child. Mom

had to drive two blocks back to the stop sign she stopped at and pick up her son. This 18 month old leaned on the door handle and fell out and mom didn't notice. This was a time before seat belts and car seats.

One of our four year olds liked to do running belly flops on our swing set seat. We warned her not to several times. One morning she was the first out the door to the back yard and took a run. We told her to stop but she kept going, hit the seat, swung into the air, did a full back flip and landed in a flower bed of Geraniums. She didn't do that again for a while. Luckily she wasn't hurt.

There was this lady who had her parents bring food for their individual children, then kept this food for her self and gave the kids cheaper generic food.

More recently we heard this story from one of our parents who left a daycare center. Apparently this center assigned certain helpers to certain children. One of the helpers didn't show up for work on time and her children were left dirty and unchanged until her arrival. We heard she later quit. Daycare helpers have a high turnover rate in this business largely because of the low pay.

One of the saddest stories I have to tell happened in our daycare. We took in this little girl not quite a year old. We'll call her Annabel, not her real name.

Mom was divorcing dad. Both were intelligent people and professionals. They apparently couldn't agree on anything between them, not even their daughter's name. Mom called her daughter Anna, and dad called her Bell. This sweet little girl didn't even have a name of her own.

This little girl was so insecure that I had to lay on the floor and sit her up next to me and let her play. If she got more than a foot away she would immediately crawl back and sit herself down. If I had to leave her to help my wife or use the bathroom, she would let out an ear-piercing scream that literally had our other daycare kids jumping out of their seats.

We put up with this for a month and realized we were worn out and not giving the proper time and care to our other kids. With a lot of regrets we gave mom notice. At this time we found out from the mother that we were her 7th daycare provider in as many months.

Gearing Down

My wife has been in family daycare for over thirty years now, and I have been in it with her full time going on twelve years. In a few years it will be time for us to retire. This article was intended for parents to better understand the daycare process and as a guiding example for those contemplating going into this profession.

During this time we've helped families raise over a hundred kids, both full time and part time. We hope we've made a positive difference to these families we call friends. We thank the LVNA newsletter, the editor and his wife, and the staff for this opportunity to briefly tell our story. We hope too, that there are people out there willing and able to pick up where we leave off. Its hard work, but very rewarding.

Thank you for taking the time to read this article. We enjoyed doing it. ■



Newsletter Walkers Needed

- Elena Anderson

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2nd Vice President	Elena Anderson	745-6028
	anderson@elmetek.com	
Secretary	Tom Freeman	734-5769
Treasurer	Bob Lacy	732-8436
Newsletter Editor	Brian Smithson	738-5939
	lvna_editor@yahoo.com	
Ad Coordinator	Mel Anderson	745-6028
	anderson@elmetek.com	

Important Phone Numbers

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Public Safety – Non-emergency		**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance		730-7506
Animal Control		730-7178
Code Enforcement		730-7610
Crime Prevention		730-7140
Hazardous Materials		730-7212
Housing Inspection		730-7610
Lakewood Pool		734-8190
Street Light Repairs		730-7510
Shopping Cart Retrieval		730-7510
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Neighborhood Preservation	Rich Gutierrez	730-7447

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Internet Links

Lakewood Village email list	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage
City of Sunnyvale	http://www.ci.sunnyvale.ca.us/
State of California	http://www.ca.gov/
Coming soon: an LVNA Web Site!	Look for details in upcoming edition of the Villager

A Volunteer Who Makes Lakewood Village Great

- Craig Crawford

I would like to recognize neighborhood volunteer Joe Levy on Manzano for his service to Lakewood Village. Joe has been cleaning up the empty lot at the corner of Sandia and Lawrence Expressway for the past few years. I was finally able to actually see him at work and asked him about his great giving to the community. Joe does the cleanup work on the neglected corner because it needs to be done, simple as that. It's volunteers like Joe who make this the best place in Sunnyvale to live. In the conversation I had with Joe, he expressed a desire to make Lakewood a better place to live, and he is not just talking, he is out putting sweat into his statement. Joe also told me he throws the best 4th of July party in Lakewood. I haven't been to it yet but if he puts as much effort into the party as the corner I have no doubt about it. Thank you Joe for you giving. ■

LVNA Meetings

- Editor

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged to attend these meetings. You will meet your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome. The next meeting is:

Date: Wednesday, March 13th
Time: 7:00 p.m.
Place: Fairwood School ■

Sunnyvale Library Bookmobile

- Editor

Fairwood School	2:15 to 3:00 p.m.
	3/19, 4/16, 4/30, 5/14, 5/28
Lakewood School	2:00 to 3:00 p.m.
3/21, 4/4, 4/18, 5/2, 5/16, 5/30 ■	



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